

Group 1

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The dataset we chose to use: Toxics Release Inventory.

Questions:

1. What industry sector and what companies specifically have released the most, and the least amount of toxins?
 - We believe that this question is newsworthy because we would be able to determine which companies are releasing the most toxins and which the least. This would somewhat show the hypocrisy of companies that claim to be “environmentally friendly.”
2. What specific chemicals are released the most, and the least? What percentage of these chemicals are United States Clean Air Act Chemicals, and what percentage are not?
 - This would be newsworthy because showing the amount of chemicals that release the toxins would give us a better understanding of how these chemicals could impact the communities that surround where the toxins are being released.
3. What percentage of the chemicals released in the country are transferred off-site? In which neighborhoods are the facilities located that receive these chemical transfers or disposals? Why are they located there?
 - It’s public interest to know who is being exposed to chemicals. Improperly handled off-site transfers can lead to chemical spills, groundwater contamination, and air pollution, which can cause health issues.
4. Do higher toxic releases correlate with higher asthma or cancer rates near these sites?
 - Newsworthy because it connects pollution to public health impacts that affect families and healthcare systems.
5. Which Maryland communities are exposed to the highest levels of toxic pollution, and are Black, low-income, or immigrant neighborhoods disproportionately affected?
 - *Newsworthy as it exposes environmental inequality and public health risks.*

Existing journalistic work:

There are many works in this domain. This investigation series by [ProPublica](#), which published company-level pollution profiles in Louisiana, is exemplary.